

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 979

By Cepicky

A RESOLUTION to honor Lieutenant Colonel Brian E. Celatka for his service on the occasion of his military retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those extraordinary Tennesseans who, through their remarkable and exceptional efforts, have gone above and beyond the call of duty by dedicating their lives to protecting the citizens of this State and nation; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Lieutenant Colonel Brian E. Celatka, who began his exemplary military career with the United States Army in January 1985; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Colonel Celatka served as an Infantryman with the 101<sup>st</sup> Airborne Division (Air Assault), deploying in support of Operations Desert Shield and Desert Storm, and with the 2<sup>nd</sup> Infantry Division, where he served within the Korean Demilitarized Zone; and

WHEREAS, in 1997, Lieutenant Colonel Celatka continued his commitment to service by joining the Tennessee National Guard, and in 2006, he was commissioned as an officer as a graduate of the United States Army Officer Candidate School, branching into the Military Police Corps; and

WHEREAS, from 2008 to 2009, Lieutenant Colonel Celatka deployed with the Tennessee National Guard and served with distinction in a joint combat assignment as the Officer in Charge of all Police Transition Team operations for United States Central Command in Baghdad, Iraq, during Operation Iraqi Freedom; and

WHEREAS, in 2010, Lieutenant Colonel Celatka transitioned to the Tennessee Air National Guard, where he held command of both a Security Forces Squadron and a Force Support Squadron, and from 2018 to 2019, he deployed to Al Udeid Air Base, Qatar, as the

Headquarters Section and Installation Security Protection Commander for the United States Air Force Central Command, Combined Air Operations Center, in support of Operations Inherent Resolve, Freedom's Sentinel, and Resolute Support; and

WHEREAS, in fitting recognition of Lieutenant Colonel Celatka's commitment to excellence throughout his career, his major awards include the Master Combat Infantryman's Badge, the Imjin Scout Badge, the Air Assault Badge, the Bronze Star Medal, the Meritorious Service Medal with three oak leaf clusters, and the Tennessee National Guard Distinguished Service Medal; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Colonel Celatka earned a Master of Military Operational Art and Science degree from the United States Air Force Air Command and Staff College and continues his commitment to public service and lifelong learning through his pursuit of a Master of Public Administration degree from the University of Tennessee, Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, in 2023, Lieutenant Colonel Celatka was selected to serve as a legislative liaison for Governor Bill Lee and as the legislative director for the Tennessee Military Department, allowing him to continue to serve the citizens of this State in a civilian capacity following his military retirement; and

WHEREAS, throughout his distinguished career, Lieutenant Colonel Brian E. Celatka has served the United States and the State of Tennessee with honor, integrity, and distinction, exemplifying the highest traditions of the Tennessee National Guard and public service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and recognize Lieutenant Colonel Brian E. Celatka of the Tennessee National Guard upon his retirement, extend our gratitude for his many years of

dutiful and valorous service, and offer our best wishes for his every future happiness and success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.